

Troop 413 Policies

Policies and Procedures for Troop 413

Last Revised: [DATE]

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Introduction

Troop 413 is a Family Scouting Unit of the Old Hickory Council, Scouting America, and is sponsored by King Moravian Church, located at 234 West Dalton Road, King NC, 27021.

Our Troop number "413" alludes to the passage of scripture found in Philippians 4:13 - "I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me". The number 13 also has significance in Moravian Church history: the first Moravian Lovefeast, held on August

13, 1727, and the November 13 commemoration of the Chief Elder Festival, dating back to 1741. Each of these dates are commemorated annually with a Lovefeast or Communion service in Moravian Churches.

The following policies are approved by the Troop Committee and with the oversight of the King Moravian Church Joint Boards. They are intended to guide Troop operations, with a goal of setting clear policies for members, leaders, and families to follow in the structure, administration, and programming of Scouting America Troop 413. While our Troop welcomes all families regardless of faith or creed, these policies are set (and at times amended) under the long-held Moravian guiding principle: "In essentials unity, in non-essentials liberty, in all things love."

Disclaimer

If any statements within this document are found to be in conflict with any policies of Scouting America or Old Hickory Council, those policies will take precedence and this document will be updated to resolve those conflicts.

Members of the Committee

A Troop Committee Member is defined as any adult volunteer who is officially registered with Scouting America in the role of Troop Committee Member and is current on all required training (including position-specific training and Safeguarding Youth policies). All registered Committee Members are invited to attend and provide input during Committee meetings.

Active Committee Members

Official Committee meeting minutes, agendas, and sensitive business documents shall be distributed exclusively to Active Committee Members to ensure focused communication and appropriate handling of committee business.

An individual is considered an Active Committee Member if they meet one of the following criteria:

- They currently hold a named, designated Troop Committee officer role (e.g., Committee Chair, Treasurer, Secretary, Advancement Chair).
 - They were recorded as present during the meeting for which the documents are being distributed.
 - They have attended two out of the last four of the Committee's regularly scheduled meetings, demonstrating sustained engagement.
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Committee Operating Structure

The Committee shall maintain a structured operating style to ensure clear accountability, transparency, and efficient management of all Troop activities and resources.

- **Quorum:** Quorum, necessary to commence or conduct business, requires a simple majority (more than fifty percent) of all active, eligible Committee members to be present.
 - **Voting Standard:** All motions, decisions, and approvals are determined by a simple majority vote of the members present, provided that quorum is met.
 - **Key Approvals:** Approval of all meeting minutes, financial expenditures, dispute resolutions, and policy decisions shall be secured by a simple majority vote of members present after quorum has been established.
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Committee Term Limits

The Committee establishes specific terms for adult volunteer roles to ensure stability and routine leadership refreshment. A Program Year is defined as July 1 through June 30.

- **Committee Chairperson:** The Chair is appointed to a one program year term and serves at the pleasure of the Chartering Organization. The Chair may be considered for additional one-year terms upon a motion and simple majority vote of the Committee, pending final approval from the Chartering Organization.
- **General Committee Roles (e.g., Treasurer, Secretary, Advancement Chair):** All general Committee members volunteering for these roles are expected to commit to a one program year term. Members are encouraged to serve continuous terms, renewing their commitment annually with the Troop Committee at the start of each Program Year.

Official Committee Role Descriptions / Expectations

Estimated time commitments do not include committee meeting attendance time.

Role	Role Description
Secretary	Keep meeting and attendance records for committee meetings; report minutes from prior meeting. <i>Time Commitment: 1h / month</i>
Treasurer	Handle troop funds; make appropriate payments as needed (e.g. reimbursements, unit charter, event registrations); provide financial report at meetings. <i>Time Commitment: 1-2h / month</i>
Quartermaster	Manage and maintain an inventory of troop equipment and gear; coordinate equipment checkout and return for troop events; identify equipment needs and bring recommendations to the committee. <i>Time Commitment: 1-2h / month, variable around campouts</i>
Advancement	Coach / support Scoutmasters and parents on inputting advancement into Scoutbook / IA; create and manage an inventory of awards on hand; create and manage the PO ahead of award ceremonies; coordinate procuring awards; validate / track after award ceremonies. <i>Time Commitment: 2h / month</i>
Activities	Work with troop leadership to plan / coordinate special event activities (e.g. Courts of Honor, Eagle ceremonies); determine themes, scripts, etc.; manage requirements (e.g. meal signups); communicate upcoming events to parents. <i>Time Commitment: 2h / month</i>
Fundraising	Coordinate fundraising opportunities (e.g. Popcorn/Peanut, Camp Cards); obtain relevant permissions for non-council-organized events; work with Treasurer to handle funds appropriately. <i>Time Commitment: variable depending on season and fundraiser</i>
Recordkeeping	Manage records for activities (med forms, permission slips, etc.); ensure compliance ahead of activities. <i>Time Commitment: < 1h / month on average, some extra work around activities</i>
Training	Communicate required (for leaders) and available training (for leaders and parents); ensure compliance ahead of activities. <i>Time Commitment: < 1h / month</i>

Money Handling

The purpose of this policy is to establish clear guidelines and procedures for the handling of all financial assets of Troop 413, ensuring transparency, accountability, and the protection of the unit's funds.

1. Authorized Signers

The Troop 413 bank account shall have a minimum of three (3) and a maximum of four (4) authorized active registered adult signers at all times. Changes to authorized signers require approval by the Troop Committee and must be promptly updated with the financial institution. Spouses/partners of the Treasurer shall not be an authorized signer.

2. Check Writing and Disbursements

- All checks written on behalf of Troop 413 require two (2) authorized signatures.
- One of the required signatures must be that of the Treasurer. In the event the Treasurer is unavailable, the Committee Chair or an authorized signer they designate may approve and provide one of the two required signatures.
- No blank checks shall be signed. All checks must be fully completed (payee, amount, date) before signatures are affixed.
- All disbursements must be supported by appropriate documentation (e.g., invoices, receipts, reimbursement requests, vendor statements). This documentation must be submitted to the Treasurer for record-keeping.

3. Cash Handling and Deposits

- All cash and checks received by the unit (e.g., from fundraisers, event registrations, dues) shall be counted by at least two (2) unrelated adult volunteers immediately upon receipt, whenever practical.
- A receipt should be issued for all cash transactions. For events with multiple transactions, a log should be maintained detailing cash received.
- All funds (cash and checks) must be deposited into the Troop 413 bank account in a timely manner, generally within three (3) business days of receipt, or as soon as the amount exceeds \$100, whichever comes first.
- Funds should never be held personally for extended periods.
- Deposit slips should be reconciled with the initial count and retained for record-keeping.

4. Expense Reimbursement

- All expenses must be pre-approved by the Treasurer or Committee Chair before the expense is incurred. Only pre-approved expenses will be reimbursed. If the Treasurer is the individual seeking reimbursement, the request must be approved by the Committee Chair.
- Individuals incurring approved expenses on behalf of the troop must submit a reimbursement request along with original receipts or detailed invoices to the Treasurer.
- Reimbursement requests should be submitted within 30 days of the expense being incurred.

5. Record Keeping and Reconciliation

- The Treasurer is responsible for maintaining accurate and up-to-date financial records for all income and expenditures using the unit's designated accounting software.
- Bank statements shall be reconciled in a timely manner by the Treasurer.
- A second authorized signer (not the Treasurer) should review the monthly bank reconciliation and initial it to confirm their review.
- All financial records, including bank statements, cancelled checks, deposit slips, receipts, and invoices, shall be retained in an organized manner for a minimum of seven (7) years, or as required by applicable tax laws and Scouting America policies.

6. Financial Reporting

- The Treasurer shall provide a financial report to the Troop Committee at each regular committee meeting, detailing income, expenditures, and current account balances.
- An annual financial report shall be presented to the Troop Committee and made available to all parents/guardians.

Scout Advancement - Record Keeping

In an effort to prevent even a hint of impropriety, leaders should not mark rank requirements or merit badge requirements complete for their own child unless the requirement is to be done as a family. Additionally, the leader should not mark the requirement "Leader Approved." A separate leader or the Advancement Chair should mark items "Leader Approved."

Upon entering rank requirements from externally-organized events (e.g. Merit Badge Colleges, Summer Camp, etc.), the Advancement Chair may mark items complete and “Leader Approved” for their own child as long as it is clearly noted where the requirements were completed.

Disagreements, impasses, or other concerns should be resolved by bringing them to the Troop Committee.

Board of Review

Scouts who have completed the necessary rank requirements and are in need of a Board of Review are responsible for contacting the Advancement Chair or the Committee Chair to schedule a Board of Review, as well as notifying the Scoutmaster of the request. Upon receiving a request, the Advancement Chair/Committee Chair will make every effort to convene a Board of Review in a timely manner.

The Board of Review must consist of no fewer than three members and no more than six. Parents, guardians, or relatives of the Scout being reviewed shall not serve on that Scout’s board. Additionally, the Scoutmaster and Assistant Scoutmasters should not serve on the board.

Scouts are strongly encouraged to appear before the review board in the Field Uniform complete with sash, though this is not a requirement.

Fundraising

Throughout the year the troop will conduct fundraising activities. The proceeds from these activities will be used to:

- Provide Scouts with the opportunity to raise money to pay their expenses for such things as summer camp, high adventure camp, camping trips, and recharter.
- Cover the costs of running the troop (e.g. storage building, merit badges, awards, leader fees, etc.)

Allocation of funds will vary depending on the fundraiser. The allocation should be clearly communicated beforehand to Scouts and their parents or guardians.

Photo Release

Troop 413 takes photos and videos of the Troop’s activities for sharing with parents/guardians and for promotional purposes (for example, posting on the Troop’s social media accounts). Troop 413 will annually request, at the beginning of the program year, that each Scout’s parent/guardian fill out a Photo Release form and make an explicit choice about whether to share these rights. Photo Release is opt-in: a lack of a form on file will be considered as not having consent. However, we ask that parents please make a choice and provide a filled out Photo Release form.

If at any time during the program year a parent or guardian wishes to withdraw their photo release, they will submit an updated photo release form to the Recordkeeping Chair and verbally notify the Scoutmaster. The Recordkeeping Chair will be responsible for maintaining these records and ensuring all leaders are aware of the current set of those who have not given consent.

Scoutbook Access

Access to individual Scout data within Scoutbook, including rosters, advancement records, medical information, and any other personally identifiable information, is strictly governed by an individual’s registered role and duties within Troop 413, aligning with Scouting America Youth Protection policies and ensuring privacy.

- The Scoutmaster shall have access to the entire troop roster and all Scout records necessary for overseeing the well-being and progress of every Scout.
 - Assistant Scoutmasters, when explicitly assigned to a specific Patrol by the Scoutmaster, will be granted access to the roster and relevant advancement records of Scouts within their assigned Patrol.
 - Key Committee members, such as the Advancement Chair and Recordkeeping Chair, will be granted the minimum necessary access required to fulfill their administrative responsibilities (e.g., managing troop-wide advancement, recharter, or contact information), as determined by the Committee Chair in consultation with the Scoutmaster.
 - All other individuals, including leaders not assigned a specific role requiring Scoutbook access, shall have no access to individual Scout records beyond what is generally visible to parents for their own Scout.
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Electronics Usage

Personal electronic devices of any kind are not necessary for adequately participating in Troop 413 events. Their use is a distraction and interferes with the goals of a given event, including safety and camaraderie. Personal electronic devices include, but are not limited to, phones, computers, tablets, gaming systems, music players, and e-readers. Medical devices, such as continuous glucose monitors, are exempt from this policy.

Use of a personal electronic device by a Scout is governed by the Troop's Code of Conduct.

The Troop will not be held liable for the loss of, or damage to, any personal electronic device brought to or used at a Troop event. Parents, guardians, and Scouts should direct all urgent communications to the Scoutmaster or event leader.

Leadership Expectations

The adult leaders of Troop 413 are expected to be role models by living the principles of the Scout Oath and Scout Law, and demonstrating these values through their actions toward Scouts, fellow leaders, and parents. Leaders must always strive to be approachable, encouraging, positive, and constructive in their interactions.

Commitment to Conduct and Accountability

All adult leaders agree to comply with the Scouter Code of Conduct (linked here: <https://www.scouting.org/health-and-safety/guidelines-policies>), as stated on the Scouting America Adult Application. Leaders are accountable for their conduct and for modeling appropriate behavior in all Troop activities.

Reporting Concerns

Concerns about a leader's conduct should first be resolved by bringing those concerns to the Troop Committee. Serious concerns regarding Safeguarding Youth violations must be reported immediately to the appropriate authorities and the Scouting America contact.

Final Authority

The chartering organization, King Moravian Church, holds the final authority for the Troop. The chartering organization must officially approve all adult leader applications and registrations before the individual may begin serving in a leadership capacity.

Program Leadership Role Definitions

Troop 413 has the following Program Leadership roles:

Scoutmaster: Provides overall leadership and direction for the Troop's youth program, acting as the primary public face and chief communicator of the program to both the Scouts and their families. This individual is responsible for being current on all required Scouting America training, and works closely with the Troop Committee to develop the annual program plan and secure necessary resources. The Scoutmaster is requested to attend all Troop Committee meetings to present a program report, seek guidance, and act as the executive liaison, serving at the pleasure of the Committee.

Assistant Scoutmaster: Supports the Scoutmaster in all duties, proactively accepts and manages ongoing program responsibilities delegated by the Scoutmaster, and assists in mentoring and supporting Scouts. This individual is a primary backup, ensuring seamless program continuity and leadership succession, and fills the role of the Scoutmaster in their absence for Scout-facing meetings and activities. The Assistant Scoutmaster serves at the pleasure of the Troop Committee.

Program Leadership Term Limits

The Committee establishes term limits for key Program Leadership roles to ensure the sustainable rotation of volunteers and leadership continuity. A Program Year is defined as July 1 through June 30.

- **Scoutmaster:** The expected service commitment for the Scoutmaster role is a one program year term. Scoutmasters are welcome to serve for additional one-year terms as desired, with agreement by the Troop Committee.
 - **Assistant Scoutmaster:** The expected service commitment for the Assistant Scoutmaster role is a one program year term. Assistant Scoutmasters are welcome to serve for additional one-year terms as desired, with agreement by the Troop Committee.
 - **Succession Planning:** The Committee Chairperson and the current Scoutmaster shall actively identify, recruit, and mentor incoming leadership in advance of any Scoutmaster transition.
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Visitor Policy

Troop 413 is an open organization that encourages prospective Scouts and their families to experience our program. Visitors are welcome to attend Troop meetings or activities up to a maximum of two (2) meetings or Troop activities for the purpose of trying out the program.

All visiting youth and their accompanying parent/guardian must check-in upon arrival and submit a signed Visitor Waiver of Liability and Emergency Contact Form prior to the start of the activity. Visitors are expected to adhere to all Troop rules and safety guidelines while participating. After the second visit, registration materials must be submitted to continue participation.

Revision History

- **[DATE]** - Initial version